

Breakout day volume. Heavy breakout volume helped the pattern perform for both breakout directions. That finding matches conventional lore where lots of sources claim that a high volume breakout helps. Here's the proof for this chart pattern. However, a survey of the chart patterns says it's only true for upward breakouts, not downward ones.

[Table 9.7](#) shows how often price reaches a stop location. I split the pattern into thirds and found how often price as it moved from the breakout to the ultimate high or low slid into one of the thirds.

For example, I found that price on the way to the ultimate high (upward breakouts) would touch the top of the chart pattern 74% of the time. So a stop placed there would trigger too often to be viable. If you moved the stop to the bottom of the pattern, price would reach it only 2% of the time, but if it were to trigger, you might see a big loss.

Thus, stop placement, where you have to balance the loss size with how often it'll be triggered, is something traders need to master.

[Table 9.8](#) shows the performance over three decades.

Performance over time. The 2010s, for upward breakouts, showed the worst performance for this chart pattern compared to the other two decades. For downward breakouts, the 2000s were worst. I excluded the two bear markets during that decade, too.

Failures over time. The most recent decade, the 2010s, showed substantially higher failure rates than the 1990s. I'm not sure why that is.

[Table 9.9](#) shows busted pattern performance.

Busted patterns count. A quarter to nearly half of broadening patterns will bust. That means price moved no more than 10% away from the breakout price before reversing and closing beyond the other side of the pattern.